Job Description: Project Associate, CM Rise Schools (Deep Academic Support)

Nature of employment: Full-time
Reporting to: (Sr.) Project Manager
Location: Ujjain or Narmadapuram Division in Madhya Pradesh

About Peepul

Peepul is an education-focused non-profit organisation committed to transforming India's education system and enabling every child to reach their full potential. We work closely with national, state, and local governments to transform government schools and government systems. Currently, we work with governments in Delhi and Madhya Pradesh to meaningfully have an impact across ~325,000 teachers and 9.75 million+ students across 100,000+ schools.

At Peepul, we collaborate with school systems to build the capacity of leaders, teachers, and institutions. We advocate for policy improvements, support mentoring and monitoring, and enhance student-teacher engagement in classrooms. Our work has been recognised internationally, including receiving the Commonwealth Education Awards for Innovation and being featured in reports by respected organisations like the UN and the National Ministry of Education, India, and we are well-funded by both Indian CSR and prominent international Foundations working toward a common purpose of excellent education for the most disadvantaged sections of society.

Driven by our core values of impact, excellence, and leadership, we are a restless, resilient, and reflective organisation. Our team of 160 employees is passionate about creating lasting change and is rewarded competitively for their dedication. Join us in our mission to create a world where every child has equal access to high-quality education. Learn more about our transformative work at http://peepulindia.org.

Programme Overview

Peepul has been partnering with the School Education Department, Govt of Madhya Pradesh, for multiple years now. Working closely with the state bureaucratic leadership, Peepul has played a meaningful role in strengthening the education system of the state.
The partnership has been a successful one – with national and international recognition of the work. One of the flagship programmes of the state we are co-leading is the **CM RISE Schools programme.** This breakthrough programme looks to build ~10,000 'world-class' public schools in the state, that enable excellence. In the first phase, there are 300 K-12 schools selected. Peepul is co-leading the Academic Support and Monitoring Unit. These schools are located at every block and need help with student learning outcomes, efficient management, and multiple challenges like infrastructure, trained human resources,

attendance, quality instruction, availability of essential resources, etc. While Peepul is supporting whole school transformation in these ~300 schools with a high priority, we are now also looking at doing a deeper intervention in the 10 out of the ~300 CM RISE schools in the Narmadapuram and Ujjain divisions in order to set these schools up as exemplars or lighthouses among these 300 schools.

We are working towards transforming ten schools in the following areas.

- Student-centered processes focused on high student outcomes and their overall development.
- Professional growth of the teachers to lead processes so they can build supportive and caring relationships with all the school's students, be proficient holders of subject matter and practice, and feel confident in applying new teaching methods.
- Building responsibility, ownership, and resourceful school leaders who can play critical roles in the growth of these schools.
- Enriching students' learning experiences - Creating pathways to enhance learning by providing world-class teaching resources like TLMs, Science and Math kits, etc.

For transfer of skills and replication of best practices - To organize learning school visits in the exemplar schools.

About the role

The Project Associate plays a critical role in Peepul's partnership with the Government of Madhya Pradesh to achieve quality education for all and improve the public school system in India. As an excellent team player, the Project Associate, will independently lead and drive the design and delivery of interventions to support and hold teachers and academic officials accountable. They will be responsible for visiting schools for observation and in-depth support to school leaders/ teachers for professional development, changing character of classrooms, implementing best practices, coordinating and preparing the schools for visits and building relationships with mid-level government stakeholders.

<u>Responsibilities would include (including but not limited to):</u>

- Lead and drive the programmatic activities in the allotted schools in close collaboration with the school teachers and HMs.
- Conduct school visits and observe classrooms to support the teachers in implementing effective assessment-based instruction.
- Support the professional development of teachers by sharing best practices and providing feedback.
- Collaborate with school leaders to develop plans for improving academic performance and conducting school level meetings.

- Build relationships with government stakeholders, to drive implementation of the program.
- Develop and maintain accurate records and reports on the progress of schools and teachers.
- Assist the Project Manager in capacity-building interventions of various stakeholders.
- Stay up to date with the latest trends and best practices in education sector.
- Define success metrics and communicate them effectively.
- Work with the M&E team and external experts to develop appropriate project evaluation tools, including academic assessment. Utilise learnings from Peepul's other programs to improve implementation.
- Create effective work-planning and management systems for prioritisation and progress tracking.
- Own and drive project implementation at scale, coordinating with Peepul's education and training team and consulting with Project Manager(s) and Programme Manager(s).
- Cultivate strong operational relationships with government partners, providing leadership and mechanisms for collaboration.
- Design and build effective partnerships with external expertise, as needed.
- Build capacity within government teams for ongoing organisational self-improvement beyond the project's end
- Any other academic or operational support required for successful implementation of the programme.

Qualifications and Role Requirements:

At Peepul, we seek talented professionals passionate about driving educational transformation and making a positive impact. We are looking for individuals who possess the following qualifications and meet the role requirements:

- **Educational Background:** A relevant educational background in Education or related disciplines is highly preferred.
- **Work Experience:** We value both professional and personal experience. Candidates with at least 2 years of experience in teaching, mentoring or education-related work are desirable. Preference will be given to candidates who also have direct classroom and teaching experience, ideally within the government school system.
- **Other Skills**: Excellent communication skills to support and influence stakeholders and ability to work independently and collaboratively with a diverse group of individuals.
- **Language Proficiency:** English and Hindi

How to apply

To apply for a position, click on the application link **here**.

You will be required to upload:

- **Your CV:** Please ensure that your CV provides relevant information about your professional and personal experience and details of your academic qualifications. CVs can be one to two pages in length.
- **A cover letter:** We highly encourage you to use your cover letter to showcase your specific interest in working for Peepul and demonstrate how your qualifications align with the role you are applying for. A tailored cover letter holds significant importance in Peepul's recruitment process as it enables us to comprehend your motivations for the position, your relevant skills, and the clarity of your writing.

For any further queries related to our hiring process and timelines, please contact us at recruitment@peepulindia.org.